Ansary Abdulrahman Diamaoden

Ansary Abdulrahman Diamaoden is a prominent Filipino development leader, peace advocate, and community organizer from Lanao del Sur.

Born December 29, 1984, Diamaoden is recognized across the Bangsamoro region for his work in peacebuilding, conflict transformation, and sustainable development.

As a Maranao leader and field-oriented practitioner, he bridges the historical struggles of the Bangsamoro independence movement with contemporary efforts to build inclusive governance and development in the Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao (BARMM).

Diamaoden currently serves as Executive Director of UNYPAD-Relief Assistance Network and Organization, Inc. (UNYPAD-RANAO), based in Marawi City, and holds leadership positions in civic and political organizations across Lanao del Sur.

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Early Life and Family Heritage

Ansary Diamaoden was born into a family deeply rooted in the Bangsamoro struggle and Maranao nobility.

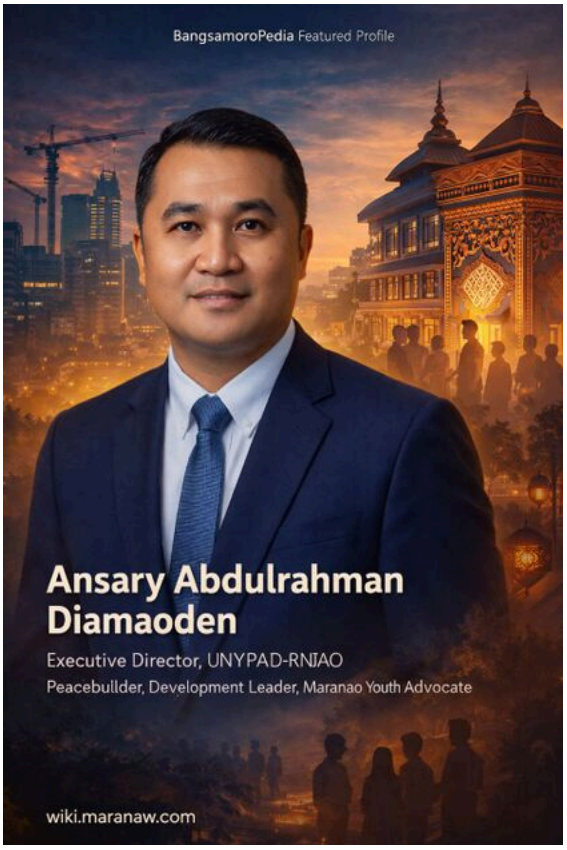
He traces his ancestry to the municipalities of Butig, Sultan Domalondong, and Lumbatan in Lanao del Sur, and belongs to the royal lineage of Dianaton Naim of Butig.

His father was the late Mohammad Nassir Alhadj, widely known by his revolutionary nom de guerre, Commander June Pha.

Commander June Pha was a highly respected figure in the Moro Islamic Liberation Front (MILF), serving as Operational Commander of the Bangsamoro Islamic Armed Forces (BIAF-MILF), founding Chief of Task Force Itehad, and co-founding Chair of the MILF Normalization Committee.

Diamaoden's upbringing within this revolutionary and peace-negotiation atmosphere significantly shaped his commitment to public service and his focus on non-violent conflict transformation as a pathway to Bangsamoro self-determination.

Education



Ansary Abdulrahman Diamaoden	
Birth Date	December 29, 1984
Birthplace	Lanao del Sur, Philippines
Ethnicity	Maranao
Religion	Islam
Education	B.S. Secondary Education (Formal); Diploma in Agri-Business Management Entrepreneurship; Master's Degree in Public Administration (MPA)
Known For	Peacebuilding, youth empowerment, conflict transformation, sustainable development
Position	Executive Director, UNYPAD-RANAO; National Vice President for External Affairs, UNYPAD Inc.
Organization	United Youth for Peace and Development (UNYPAD)

Formal Academic Training

Diamaoden's educational foundation combines secular administration, vocational entrepreneurship, and religious scholarship.

He holds a Bachelor of Science in Secondary Education and a Diploma in Agri-Business Management Entrepreneurship.

He furthered his expertise by earning a Master's Degree in Public Administration (MPA), with focus on governance and institutional management.

He pursued Arabic studies at Sanie Sanawie, deepening his understanding of Islamic scholarship and Maranao cultural heritage.

Peace Education and Professional Development

His perspective on conflict resolution and peacebuilding was shaped by specialized training at the Mindanao Peacebuilding Institute (MPI) in Davao City and the ICF Asia School of Peace in India.

International Exposure

Diamaoden has participated in diverse international training and study programs across multiple continents.

In Thailand, he underwent journalism advocacy training to strengthen his communication skills.

Nepal provided him community organizing training grounded in grassroots mobilization approaches.

He received human rights training in Hong Kong, broadening his understanding of international standards and advocacy frameworks.

In Turkey, he engaged in administration and policy advocacy training in Istanbul, gaining exposure to governance practices beyond Southeast Asia.

An Indonesia study tour to Banda Aceh allowed him to analyze post-conflict recovery mechanisms and regional autonomy arrangements relevant to the Bangsamoro context.

These international exposures have informed his approach to development work, integrating global best practices with local Maranao and Bangsamoro contexts.

Professional Career and Leadership

UNYPAD and Youth-Led Development

Diamaoden is a central figure in the United Youth for Peace and Development (UNYPAD), a leading youth-led non-governmental organization serving Muslim Mindanao.

As Executive Director of UNYPAD-RANAO, based in Marawi City, Diamaoden oversees regional development programs addressing the complex needs of Lanao's post-conflict communities.

Simultaneously, he serves as the National Vice President for External Affairs of UNYPAD Inc., managing the organization's partnerships and linkages with national and international stakeholders.

His work focuses on capacity building for community-based organizations and youth groups, conflict transformation through dialogue facilitation and peace education, and sustainable development initiatives that address social and economic challenges in the Bangsamoro region.

In August 2025, Diamaoden convened youth leaders from 20 barangays in Lanao del Sur for the Youth Peace Summit 2025, themed "Empowered Youth, Inspiring Change."

> Their voices, their leadership, and their courage are the strongest foundations upon which we can build a more united Bangsamoro.

Diamaoden's leadership recognizes young people not merely as future stakeholders in peacebuilding but as present-day leaders, innovators, and changemakers capable of transforming their communities.

Civic and Political Engagement

In addition to his NGO work, Diamaoden plays an active role in the political and governance landscape of Lanao del Sur.

He serves as Provincial President for the ABOT Party, engaging in local governance and political reform initiatives.

He also holds the position of General Secretary within Sapolo Ago Isakalukes a Moriato Barakat, an organization emphasizing community solidarity and collective leadership.

Core Areas of Work

Diamaoden's professional approach is characterized by direct field engagement and a commitment to grassroots development.

His work prioritizes the voices and needs of marginalized sectors, fostering participatory development that centers community agency rather than top-down interventions.

He integrates local customs and Islamic values into modern peacebuilding frameworks, recognizing that sustainable peace requires cultural and religious grounding in Bangsamoro contexts.

As a lecturer, Diamaoden frequently discusses the historical roots of the Bangsamoro struggle for self-determination, providing context for current peace and autonomy efforts.

He serves as a bridge between the historical struggles of the older generation of Bangsamoro leaders and the contemporary needs of a generation seeking inclusive development and reformed governance.

Legacy and Vision

Diamaoden embodies a generation of Bangsamoro leaders who inherited both the aspirations and unfinished work of the independence struggle while seeking to channel these energies toward inclusive development and institutional transformation.

His insistence on youth leadership, cultural integration, and field-oriented practice reflects a belief that lasting peace emerges from communities taking ownership of their own futures rather than waiting for top-down solutions.

Through UNYPAD-RANAO and his civic roles, Diamaoden continues to expand the space for young Maranao and Bangsamoro voices in both development and governance, modeling an approach that honors heritage while building new institutions.

Further Reading

- Mindanao Peacebuilding Institute (MPI) publications on youth and conflict transformation
- UNYPAD organizational documentation and program reports
- Philippine peace process and Bangsamoro autonomy governance materials

See Also

- Bangsamoro Autonomous Region in Muslim Mindanao
- Moro Islamic Liberation Front
- Lanao del Sur
- Marawi City
- Maranao people
- Peace Education
- Youth Leadership in the Philippines

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